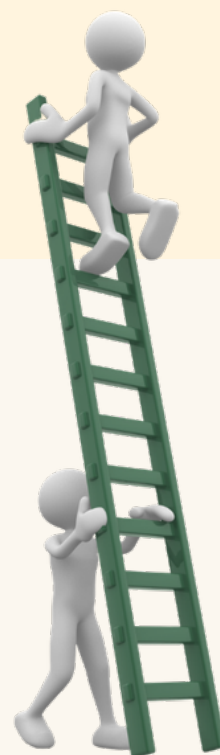


# English Ladder

## Student Workbook

### Understanding Prepositions: in/on/at

A polished self-study handout designed for print or tablet use. Read the concept, notice the pattern, and then complete the matching practice set on your own.



Grammar Concepts #01

General Rules

Location

Time

Information and Other Uses

#### Visual anchor

Use the concept poster to spotlight the main language pattern in **Understanding Prepositions: in/on/at** and keep the explanation visible during practice and discussion.

**ENGLISH LADDER**

*Concept #01* ▶ **Prepositions: in/on/at**

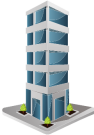
Generally, **at** is for a point, **on** is for something larger, and **in** is for the largest category.



I was **in** New York.

I was **on** Wall Street.

I was **at** the Empire State Building.



I was **in** the Empire State Building.

I was **on** the 12th floor.

I was **at** the elevator.



I was busy **in** February.

I will celebrate my birthday **on** April 2.

I will eat lunch **at** 11:45.



There is much information **in** the book.

There is more information **on** page 32.

The page number is **at** the top of the page.

**at** **on** **in**

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## Core Idea

Prepositions are words used to show the relationship of a noun or pronoun to other words in a sentence. They often indicate location, time, or direction. This guide will explain the use of the prepositions in, on, and at, which are commonly used to express these relationships.

## General Rules

- in: Used for the largest categories, such as cities, countries, months, and years.
- on: Used for more specific items like streets, surfaces, and dates.
- at: Used for the most specific points, such as exact locations, times, and specific places.

## Location

### in (Largest Category)

- City/Country:
  - Example: "I was in New York."
  - Example: "She lives in Japan."
- Building/Enclosed Space:
  - Example: "He is in the library."
  - Example: "We met in the cafe."

### on (More Specific)

- Streets:
  - Example: "I was on Wall Street."
  - Example: "The store is on Main Street."
- Surfaces:
  - Example: "The book is on the table."
  - Example: "There is a painting on the wall."
- Floors of a Building:
  - Example: "I was on the 12th floor."
  - Example: "She works on the second floor."

### at (Most Specific)

- Exact Locations:



- Example: "I was at the Empire State Building."
- Example: "We will meet at the entrance."
- Specific Places within a Building:
- Example: "I was at the elevator."
- Example: "He is at the reception desk."

## Time

### **in (Larger Periods)**

- Months/Years:
- Example: "I was busy in February."
- Example: "She was born in 1990."
- Seasons:
- Example: "We travel a lot in the summer."
- Example: "The flowers bloom in spring."

### **on (Specific Days/Dates)**

- Days of the Week/Dates:
- Example: "I will celebrate my birthday on April 2."
- Example: "We have a meeting on Monday."
- Specific Days/Events:
- Example: "He arrived on Christmas Day."
- Example: "They left on New Year's Eve."

### **at (Exact Times)**

- Specific Times:
- Example: "I will eat lunch at 11:45."
- Example: "The train arrives at 3:30 PM."
- Holiday Periods/Specific Moments:
- Example: "We opened presents at midnight."
- Example: "She woke up at dawn."

## Information and Other Uses

**in**



- Books/Media:
- Example: "There is much information in the book."
- Example: "I read it in the newspaper."

**on**

- Pages/Sections:
- Example: "There is more information on page 32."
- Example: "I saw it on the website."

**at**

- Specific Points in a Document:
- Example: "The page number is at the top of the page."
- Example: "Look at the beginning of the chapter."

## Additional Examples

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**in**

- "I live in a big house."
- "They are in the car."
- "We will visit them in December."

**on**

- "She left her keys on the counter."
- "He wrote his name on the board."
- "The concert is on Friday."

**at**

- "He is at the supermarket."
- "She is waiting at the bus stop."
- "The meeting starts at noon."

Understanding the use of in, on, and at can greatly improve your ability to express locations, times, and other relationships in English. Practice using these prepositions in sentences, and soon it will become natural.



## Practice Check

Answer the quiz questions below with responses consistent with the grammar concepts taught on the left.

**ITEM 01**

I was \_\_\_\_ New York.

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**ITEM 02**

She lives \_\_\_\_ Japan.

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**ITEM 03**

The store is \_\_\_\_ Main Street.

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**ITEM 04**

The book is \_\_\_\_ the table.

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**ITEM 05**

I was \_\_\_\_ the Empire State Building.

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**ITEM 06**

She works \_\_\_\_ the second floor.

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**ITEM 07**

We will meet \_\_\_\_ the entrance.

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**ITEM 08**

He is \_\_\_\_ the library.

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**ITEM 09**

I will celebrate my birthday \_\_\_\_ April 2.

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**ITEM 10**

We have a meeting \_\_\_\_ Monday.

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_



## ITEM 11

I will eat lunch \_\_\_\_ 11:45.

\_\_\_\_\_

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

## ITEM 12

She was born \_\_\_\_ 1990.

\_\_\_\_\_

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

## ITEM 13

The flowers bloom \_\_\_\_ spring.

\_\_\_\_\_

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

## ITEM 14

He arrived \_\_\_\_ Christmas Day.

\_\_\_\_\_

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

## ITEM 15

The train arrives \_\_\_\_ 3:30 PM.

\_\_\_\_\_

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

## ITEM 16

We opened presents \_\_\_\_ midnight.

\_\_\_\_\_

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

## ITEM 17

There is much information \_\_\_\_ the book.

\_\_\_\_\_

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

## ITEM 18

I saw it \_\_\_\_ the website.

\_\_\_\_\_

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

## ITEM 19

The page number is \_\_\_\_ the top of the page.

\_\_\_\_\_

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

## ITEM 20

Look \_\_\_\_ the beginning of the chapter.

\_\_\_\_\_

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

## ITEM 21

He left his keys \_\_\_\_ the counter.

\_\_\_\_\_

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

## ITEM 22

She wrote her name \_\_\_\_ the board.

\_\_\_\_\_

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_



ITEM 23

I live \_\_\_\_ a big house.

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

ITEM 24

She is waiting \_\_\_\_ the bus stop.

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_



## Self-check Answer Key

Use the key after you have completed every item on your own.

**Item 01** I was in New York.

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**Item 02** She lives in Japan.

---

**Item 03** The store is on Main Street.

---

**Item 04** The book is on the table.

---

**Item 05** I was at the Empire State Building.

---

**Item 06** She works on the second floor.

---

**Item 07** We will meet at the entrance.

---

**Item 08** He is in the library.

---

**Item 09** I will celebrate my birthday on April 2.

---

**Item 10** We have a meeting on Monday.

---

**Item 11** I will eat lunch at 11:45.

---

**Item 12** She was born in 1990.

---

**Item 13** The flowers bloom in spring.

---

**Item 14** He arrived on Christmas Day.

---

**Item 15** The train arrives at 3:30 PM.

---

**Item 16** We opened presents at midnight.

---

**Item 17** There is much information in the book.

---

**Item 18** I saw it on the website.

---

**Item 19** The page number is at the top of the page.

---

**Item 20** Look at the beginning of the chapter.

---

**Item 21** He left his keys on the counter.

---





**Item 22** She wrote her name on the board.

**Item 23** I live in a big house.

**Item 24** She is waiting at the bus stop.